



GD1 A3 - Individual Reflection Prompts:

These are the questions to answer in your individual documents and may be helpful prompts for explaining your reasoning and design decisions.

Stage 1: From Cards to Boards (Introducing Space & State)

Focus: movement, objectives, spatial thinking

Key Questions:

- How do game decisions change when you introduce a game board?
- What's the difference between choosing an action and choosing a direction?
- How can we visualize all the possible outcomes from a single move?
- What constraints should we put on movement, and why?
- What role does the shape or layout of the board play in how the game feels?

Stage 2: Introducing Utility and Tradeoffs

Focus: cost/benefit, priorities, evaluating outcomes

Key Questions:

- How can we assign value to a square, action, or position?
- What makes one move better than another?
- Are short-term gains always better than long-term advantages?
- How can we represent risk in our game? Should we?
- How can we make players choose between “good” options?

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Stage 3: Planning Paths and Evaluating States

Focus: sequences of moves, pathfinding, spatial strategy

Key Questions:

- What does the “best path” look like in this game? How do we know?
- Are all paths equally rewarding? If not, what makes one better?
- How can we reduce the number of choices without making the game boring?
- Can you design a layout that forces the player to think ahead?
- How would an AI make choices in your board game?

Stage 4: Playtest, Reflect, Iterate

Focus: player experience, emergent behavior, feedback

Key Questions:

- Which parts of the game led to the most interesting decisions?
- Did players find dominant strategies? Should they be allowed to?
- Did your design reward smart planning or luck more?
- What would you change to increase meaningful choices?
- What surprised you during playtesting?